

SUCCESS IS MEASURED BY EFFORT AND DEDICATION, NOT JUST MEDALS

Mary D'Souza Sequeira **made history** as one of India's first female Olympians when she debuted at the 1952 Helsinki Olympics and later set Asian records in short sprints by 1956.



Team Sportstar

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Athlete, hockey player, trailblazer – Mary D'Souza Sequeira is all those things and more. Coming from the vibrant neighbourhood of Bandra in the 1950s, she emerged as a champion sprinter.

A formidable athlete, she smashed national records and claimed gold, silver, and bronze medals at the Asian Games in Delhi (1951) and Manila (1954). She made history as one of India's first female Olympians when she debuted at the 1952 Helsinki Olympics and later set Asian records in short sprints by 1956. But Mary's prowess didn't end with track and field – she also represented India in field hockey, becoming the nation's first female double international. Nearly seven decades ago, Mary's speed, resilience, and groundbreaking achievements made her a household name and an enduring icon in Indian sports.

Mary, now based in the USA with her children, has always been a fighter, and at the age of 93, she has battled glaucoma, congestive heart failure, and breast cancer – all with